General Assembly for Dummies (GF for Dummies)

Eclipse NMBU

A plain-language, non-binding guide: ECL-H2026-DUMMY-01

Eclipse NMBU
Norwegian University of Life Sciences, Norway

Ås, October 13, 2026

Contact: post@eclipsenmbu.no

Contents

What is a General Assembly? 1

Who can vote? 1

Constitution of the Meeting 1

The Agenda 1

What's a Case? 1

How to read a Case Paper 1

Right to Propose 2

How to submit an Amendment 2

Floor Amendments: really, Floor Nominations 2

Advance Nominations 2

Hand signals 2

Voting 2

Two-thirds majority 2

Election procedure 3

Voting Order 3

Protocol 3

When do decisions become effective? 3

What happens after the General Assembly? 3

Document ID: ECL-H2026-DUMMY-01
This document is not binding. If anything here conflicts with the Bylaws, the Notice of Meeting, the Agenda, or any other formal document in this set, those documents control: this is just a friendly explanation to help you follow along at your first General Assembly (generalforsamling, or "GF").

What is a General Assembly?

The General Assembly (generalforsamling) is Eclipse NMBU's supreme decision-making meeting. It's where the whole membership: not just the Board: gets to vote on the big things: the budget, the rules (Bylaws), and who sits on the Board next.

Who can vote?

Board Members, Core Members and Active Members can vote. Everyone: including Inactive Members: is welcome to attend, listen, and speak, but only those three tiers can actually cast a vote or stand for election. See the Glossary (ECL-H2026-GLOSS-01) if you're not sure which tier you're in.

Constitution of the Meeting

Before anything else can happen, the meeting has to "constitute" itself: elect someone to chair the meeting (Meeting Chair), someone to take minutes (Secretary), two people to count votes (Vote Counters), and two people to check and sign the final minutes (Protocol Signers). This also includes approving the Notice and the Agenda. Nothing else can be validly decided until this is done.

The Agenda

The Agenda (saksliste) is the running order for the meeting: the list of everything that will be discussed and voted on, in order. You can find it as ECL-H2026-AGD-01.

What's a Case?

A Case (sak) is one item of business: one thing the General Assembly is being asked to decide. Each Case has its own Case Paper.

How to read a Case Paper

Every Case Paper (sakspapir) follows the same template (ECL-H2026-TPL-01), so once you know the shape, you can read any of them: what's the background (why are we talking about this?), what's the actual proposal (what are we being asked to vote for?), and any other information you need to make up your mind.

Right to Propose

Right to Propose (forslagsrett) is the right to submit a new Case, or an Amendment to an existing one. At this General Assembly, that means Board Members, Core Members and Active Members: the same people who can vote.

How to submit an Amendment

An Amendment (endringsforslag) is a proposed change to a Case that's already on the Agenda. You write down exactly what you want changed and what you want it changed to, and submit it before the deadline (see the Notice of Meeting, ECL-H2026-NOT-01). Full details are in the Amendment Submission Procedure, ECL-H2026-PROC-01. **You can't submit an Amendment to a Case's wording after the deadline**: there's no last-minute exception.

Floor Amendments: really, Floor Nominations

You'll sometimes hear "floor amendment" (benkeforslag) used loosely, but in this document set it has one specific meaning: nominating a *candidate* for election directly from the floor, during the meeting itself, rather than in advance. It's not a way to sneak in a last-minute change to a Case's text: that's not allowed after the Amendment deadline.

Advance Nominations

If you want to run for a Board position, you can let the Board know before the meeting: that's an Advance Nomination (forhåndsbenking). You'll then appear as a candidate on the Agenda. You can also be nominated from the floor on the day.

Hand signals

all signals are done by showing your vote number, and a fingure gesture. inlegg is 1 finger up and number in portrait, respikk is 2 fingers and the voting plaket in landskape. after a replikk the original inlegsholder can show 3 fingers to th eordstyrer to indekate thay want a svar replik. makig a questionmark (bent finger) and the coting balet in protrait is "saksoplysning"

Voting

Most votes are decided by simple majority: more than half of the votes cast, not counting blanks. Voting is usually by show of hands, unless someone asks for a written and secret vote.

Two-thirds majority

Some decisions need more than a simple majority. Changing the Bylaws needs **2/3 of all Eclipse NMBU members**: not just those in the room: to vote in favour. That's a high bar on purpose: it's the Association's constitution.

Election procedure

Board elections are one role at a time. If a candidate gets a majority, they're elected. If nobody does, there's a second round between the top candidates. Blank votes count in the first round, but can be squeezed out in a second round if nobody wins.

Voting Order

Before voting starts, the Meeting Chair proposes an order to vote in: usually Amendments first, then the underlying proposal: designed to use as few individual votes as possible. See ECL-H2026-VOTORD-01 for the full logic, including the special two-stage process for the Bylaw Amendment.

Protocol

The Protocol (protokoll) is the official written record of everything the General Assembly decided: every proposal, every vote count, every election result. Once the two Protocol Signers have checked and signed it, it's the final, authoritative account of the meeting.

When do decisions become effective?

Most resolutions take effect as soon as they're passed. Bylaw Amendments are a bit different: under the proposed New Bylaws, they take effect once the Protocol is signed, unless the General Assembly says otherwise.

What happens after the General Assembly?

The Protocol gets published (within two weeks). Newly elected Board members take up their roles (with an overlap/handover period). If the Bylaw Amendment passed, work starts on rolling out the new structure: new Membership Contracts, Responsibility Contracts for anyone taking on a leadership role, and so on. If you're curious how any of that works, most of it is written down somewhere in this same document set.